



Garden Notes



ZUCCHINI



- ✦ Zucchini does not need your full emotional support. It mostly needs sun, space, and for you to check under the leaves before it starts producing garden baseball bats.
- ✦ Plant one or two zucchini plants unless you are emotionally prepared to become the neighborhood zucchini supplier.
- ✦ If the zucchini looks dramatic in the heat, check the soil before assuming it has entered its final chapter.

TOMATOES

- 🍅 Tomatoes like support, consistency, and a little patience.
- 🍅 A tomato plant does not need perfection. It needs sun, steady water, and something to lean on when life gets heavy.
- 🍅 If a tomato is cracked, weird, or slightly ugly, congratulations. You may have just grown sauce.



PEPPERS



- 🌶️ Peppers are basically waiting for warm weather to convince them life is worth participating in.
- 🌶️ Peppers do not appreciate being rushed. Give them heat, sun, and time to think about becoming useful.
- 🌶️ Green peppers are not failed peppers. They are just peppers who left the party early.

POTATOES

- 🥔 You are planting a potato that already knows how to be a potato.
- 🥔 Stick your finger about 1-2 inches into the soil. If it feels moist, leave it alone. If it feels dry, water. If it feels like soup, apologize to the potato and step away from the hose.



BUTTERNUT SQUASH



- 🍂 Butternut squash is a long game. Plant it, give it room, and try not to take its sprawling personally.
- 🍂 This plant will wander. That does not mean you failed. It means the squash has goals.
- 🍂 When the vine looks ridiculous and the fruit looks like it is taking forever, that is probably normal.

WATERING

- 💧 Water the soil, not the plant's hair.
- 💧 Deep watering is better than tiny daily sprinkles. Your plants want a drink, not a decorative misting.
- 💧 Before you panic-water, poke the soil. The soil knows things.



HARVESTING

- ✦ Harvesting is not a one-time grand event. It is more like wandering outside with a bowl and discovering dinner.
- ✦ Use what is ready, freeze what you can, share what you cannot face eating, and call that a plan.
- ✦ The goal is not to preserve everything perfectly. The goal is to avoid letting your vegetables haunt you from the counter.

